

CONTROLLED UNCLASSIFIED INFORMATION

Sole Source (Including Brand Name) Justification - Simplified Procedures for Certain Commercial Items

NOTE: If a Justification was approved for the preceding acquisition, a copy of the approved Justification for the predecessor action must be included in the staff package for approval of the instant Justification. This applies to Justification staff packages that are submitted for review and approval at a level above the contracting officer. The predecessor Justification will be used as a reference document by the approving official.

Is this a new or amended J&A Document? ☒ New ☐ Amended (Prior to Award Only!)

Is this a Bridge Action as defined in the [AF Bridge Action Reduction Plan](#)? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Funding level for this acquisition: ☐ >SAT and ≤ \$750K ☒ > \$750K and ≤ \$15M

Contracting Activity: 31 CONS/PKB

Purchase Request / Local ID Number: TBD

Program / Project (and PE, if applicable): Telecommunication Commercial Fixed Services

Program Type (PEO or Other Contracting): Service

Authority: ☒ AFFARS 5313.501 - 10 U.S.C. 3572, Implementation of Simplified Acquisition Procedures (41 U.S.C. 1901)

☐ AFFARS 5313.501 - 10 U.S.C. 3403, Special Emergency Procurement Authority (41 U.S.C. 1903)

Estimated Contract Cost (including options): [REDACTED] Justification Type: ☐ Class ☒ Individual

COORDINATION ([AFFARS 5306.304\(a\)](#))

Date 04 Mar 2026	Project Lead / Program Mgr / Requiring Activity Mr. Bryan Szafraneck 31 CS/SCXP / 632-7526	Signature SZAFRANEK.BRYAN.PA TRICK.1266726615 Digitally signed by SZAFRANEK.BRYAN.PATRICK.1266726615 Date: 2026.03.10 12:14:42 +01'00'
Date 16 Mar 2026	Contracting Specialist Ms. Barbara Francescon 31 CONS/PKBY / 632-7950	Signature FRANCESCON.BARBAR A.1629175438 Digitally signed by FRANCESCON.BARBARA.1629175438 Date: 2026.03.16 11:53:42 +01'00'
Date 16 Mar 2026	Contracting Officer Mr. Gualtiero Casadio 31 CONS/PKBY / 632-7931	Signature CASADIO.GUALTIERO.1 539120669 Digitally signed by CASADIO.GUALTIERO.1539120669 Date: 2026.03.16 11:32:40 +01'00'
Date 16 Mar 2026	Contracting Officer Mr. Adam L Bernas 31 CONS/PKB / 632-8558	Signature BERNAS.ADAM.L.13873 55797 Digitally signed by BERNAS.ADAM.L.1387355797 Date: 2026.03.16 16:14:23 +01'00'

APPROVAL ([AFFARS 5306.304\(a\)](#))

Date	Competition Advocate	Signature

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I. Contracting Activity.

31 Contracting Squadron Aviano/PKB, Aviano Air Base Italy

II. Nature and/or description of the action being processed.

The 31st Communications Squadron has a requirement for establishing a contract (base + years option) to provide 31st Fighter Wing, GSUs and supported organizations with telecommunications commercial fixed services. This involves transformation/adaptation of "generic" ADSL lines, analog (POTS) and Basic ISDN (BRI) lines and three Primary ISDN (PRI) trunks, which provide commercial calling capability (both incoming and outgoing) to the entire base. The services requested include activation, deactivation, maintenance, relocation and billing for current and future services. [REDACTED] is mandated by the Italian Authority to terminate the copper-based technology lines by May 2026 which involves transformation of old Aviano AB lines. The current Aviano AB technical configuration is based on a very old contract/partnership with [REDACTED] since the sixties when it was called [REDACTED] and was the only public telecommunication provider in Italy.

III. Description of supplies/services required to meet agency needs.

The contractor is required to provide all appropriate personnel, equipment, tools, materials, supervision, transportation and all other items and services necessary to decommission ISDN PRI trunks and to replace them with a Trunksip solution as well as POT/ISDN lines replacement with Premium Business XDSL and ADSL line replacement with Internet Professional. The contractor will also provide installation, activation, billing and maintenance for the above mentioned services currently operating in Aviano AB, GSUs and supported organizations and for future ones.

IV. Statutory authority permitting other than full and open competition.

FAR Overhaul 12.102 Restricting Competition; 41 U.S.C. 1901

V. Demonstration that the contractor's unique qualifications or nature of the acquisition requires the use of the authority cited above (applicability of authority).

[REDACTED] is the current main provider of fixed communications services for Aviano AB. Historically, Aviano AB has shared a mixed telecommunications infrastructure ownership with [REDACTED] which dates to the time before the opening of Italian telecommunication market to the other carriers. Aviano Base's had a partnership with [REDACTED] since when it was called [REDACTED] and was the only authorized telecommunication provider. Based on this long term relationship [REDACTED] has gained over the years a competitive advantage (made of competence and technical knowledge of Aviano AB telecommunication infrastructure) that cannot be equaled by no other competitor in the current telecommunication open market. [REDACTED] current infrastructure is also utilized to provide commercial service to other organizations other than 31st Fighter Wing that are not included in our current contract (i.e. AAFES, base contractors, NAF Agencies, Long Haul circuits for Tech Control). [REDACTED] technicians have acquired a deep knowledge of the base structure and infrastructure and specific needs. Customized technical solutions have also been provided over the years. As directed by the Italian Communications Competition Authority through resolutions 333/20/CONS [REDACTED] is terminating copper-based technology lines by May 2026. This is the first set of lines that will be transferred to a newer technology but future ones will be impacted, too. For service continuity purposes and to avoid disruptions, particularly critical are the 3 ISDN PRI trunks which provide the whole base with incoming and outgoing commercial calling capability, it was determined not to be in the best interest of the Government to compete this requirement full and open.

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VI. Description of efforts made to ensure that offers are solicited from as many potential sources as practicable.

The 31 CS conducted a survey/market research which demonstrated that other sources available in the open market do not possess the knowledge and specific capabilities required to ensure professional performance. If other companies competing for this requirement were to be awarded with a contract to execute it, they would be forced to spend time and resources studying the installed technological base and subsequently implementing the most suitable technical solution to ensure the requested transition. Of course, it is unlikely that they would be able to deliver what is required to the 31 CS by May 26, 2026, thereby exposing Aviano Air Base to unacceptable disruptions or installation/configuration problems, as well as higher costs to the Government. However, the 31 CS is pursuing ongoing research, even by hiring a Telecommunications SME, to prepare a technical-detailed requirement suitable for a full and open competition, if a similar requirement should arise in the near future.

VII. Determination by the Contracting Officer that the anticipated cost to the Government will be fair and reasonable.

The anticipated cost of this acquisition will be evaluated for determination of fair and reasonableness prior to award [REDACTED]. Technical representatives will review and evaluate [REDACTED]'s proposal to support the price fair and reasonable determination. Although certified cost and pricing data is exempt based on commerciality, the Contracting Officer will request other than certified cost and pricing data from [REDACTED] will be required to provide a technical approach that will be evaluated by the technical evaluator to ensure that [REDACTED] understands the requirement and the proposal meets the requirements identified in the SOO.

VIII. Description of the market research conducted and the results, or a statement of the reasons market research was not conducted.

A research was conducted to verify whether the equipment that needs to be upgraded was installed in the past through contracts with a full and open competition. Unfortunately, the research yielded no results, highlighting that such equipment was installed before 1998, the year in which the telecommunications market was liberalized at the Italian and European levels, with the complete opening to competition for fixed telephony services. The research therefore demonstrates that this equipment was installed by [REDACTED], at a time when there was no competition in the telecommunications market. It also shows how [REDACTED] has direct knowledge of these systems, having installed and maintained them over the years. Based on the above, [REDACTED] is the only entity capable of offering an upgrade (to allow a smooth transition from legacy copper-based technologies to modern fiber optic infrastructure as mandated by the Italian Telecommunication Authority) of Aviano AB telecommunication infrastructure, having direct technical knowledge of it as well as its location, which, unlike other potential competitors, allows [REDACTED] to offer a competitive service not only in terms of price and time but, above all, qualified and adequate from a technological standpoint.

IX. Any other facts supporting the use of Other Than Full and Open Competition.

Terms and conditions offered to the Government are substantially similar to those used in the commercial market where regulations by Italian Ministry of Economic Development of Communication have to be complied by all Italian commercial companies.

X. List of any sources that expressed, in writing, an interest in the acquisition.

N/A

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XI. A statement of the actions, if any, the agency may take to remove or overcome any barriers to competition before making subsequent acquisitions for the supplies or services required.

Currently no other companies in the Italian market are known possessing the same expertise and the same historical technical background for ensuring a smooth and problem free upgrade of the Aviano AB telecommunication infrastructure. However, should future pre-requisites/conditions change and barriers to open and full competition be removed, they will be actively monitored. Consequently, new available sources will be solicited for competitive quotations.

XII. Certification by the Contracting Officer.

As evidenced by my signature above, I have determined this document to be both accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

XIII. Certification by the technical/requirements personnel.

As evidenced by my (our) signature(s) above, I (we) certify that any supporting data contained herein, which is my (our) responsibility, is both accurate and complete.